

M01 PROTECTED REVIEW & TARGETED REPAIR

OPEN ONLY AFTER A GENUINE SAVED ATTEMPT. This pack diagnoses weak competencies; it is not a pre-attempt answer key.

DE01-01 - What data is: tables, records, fields and data types

Expected checkpoint

You should be able to point at any value and say both what column it belongs to and what business thing the entire row represents.

Common errors + safe repair

- A value looking like a date does not guarantee Excel stored it as a true date.
 - Formatting is appearance; data type is how the value behaves.
 - Do not assume every number should be added. OrderID contains digits but is an identifier, not a quantity.
- Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

BUILD -> TRANSFER -> PROVE

After repair

Close this pack. Repeat a changed/fresh task from the independent practice or fresh-retest route. Re-typing the reviewed answer is not mastery.

DE01-02 - Grain: what one row represents

Expected checkpoint

Before counting, joining or summarizing, you can say "one row represents ..." in plain English.

Common errors + safe repair

- Saying "grain = customer" just because CustomerID exists.
 - Counting rows as orders without proving the table is one row per order.
- Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-03 - Keys, duplicates, NULLs and missing data

Expected checkpoint

You do not delete a repeat until you can explain why it violates the key/grain.

Common errors + safe repair

- Using "Remove Duplicates" before deciding the key.
 - Replacing blanks with 0 just to make them disappear.
- Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-04 - Data quality dimensions and validation thinking

Expected checkpoint

Every quality claim becomes a concrete test: column + rule + what failure looks like.

Common errors + safe repair

- Writing "check data quality" without a test.

- Confusing uniqueness with "no repeated values anywhere".

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-05 - Meet Excel: workbook, worksheet, cells and formulas

Expected checkpoint

You understand the difference between what the cell displays and the formula stored behind it.

Common errors + safe repair

- Typing 1700 manually instead of $=B2*C2$.

- Typing $B2*C2$ without the leading $=$.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-06 - Enter, save and structure tabular data safely

Expected checkpoint

The original workbook remains unchanged, and your working copy contains your experiments.

Common errors + safe repair

- Editing the only copy of the raw file.

- Using two header rows or merged cells as decoration inside source data.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-07 - Sort and filter without damaging data

Expected checkpoint

Filtering never deletes the hidden rows; sorting keeps OrderID, customer, product, Qty and price aligned on the same record.

Common errors + safe repair

- Deleting hidden rows because they are not visible.
- Sorting one column by itself and scrambling row relationships.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-08 - Basic formulas and essential functions

Expected checkpoint

Changing a Qty or UnitPrice automatically changes the calculated Sales; formulas appear in the formula bar.

Common errors + safe repair

- Typing answers instead of formulas.
- Using COUNT on text IDs and thinking zero means there are no records.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-09 - Relative and absolute references

Expected checkpoint

One setting cell controls every row without repeating the percentage in each formula.

Common errors + safe repair

- Using H2 without dollar signs and watching it drift to H3/H4.
- Typing 18% directly in every row formula.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-10 - Excel Tables and structured data habits

Expected checkpoint

The object expands with new rows and keeps explicit headers/filters.

Common errors + safe repair

- Assuming coloured formatting means the data is an Excel Table.

- Creating a Table from an incomplete range that omits columns.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-11 - Practical cleaning and lookup awareness

Expected checkpoint

Known IDs return the same Tier shown in Customer_Lookup; C999 is clearly flagged missing.

Common errors + safe repair

- Matching by CustomerName when CustomerID is the intended key.

- Treating unmatched IDs as blank and forgetting to investigate them.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-12 - PivotTable and Power Query awareness

Expected checkpoint

You can answer which Region has the highest sales and describe Power Query as repeatable transformation rather than "another worksheet".

Common errors + safe repair

- Building a fancy dashboard before understanding the summary.

- Using Count of Sales by accident.

- Manually cleaning source values one-by-one and calling that a repeatable pipeline.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-13 - Chart choice and basic visual communication

Expected checkpoint

A reader can answer the business question quickly without decoding unnecessary colours or 3-D effects.

Common errors + safe repair

- Using a line chart for unordered categories.
- Adding 3-D effects that distort comparisons.
- Making the title vague.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-14 - Reconciliation, sanity checks and source preservation

Expected checkpoint

You can show both the result and one independent check that supports it.

Common errors + safe repair

- Trusting a pretty PivotTable because it looks professional.
- Changing raw data to force agreement.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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DE01-15 - Mini workflow: inspect -> calculate -> validate -> explain ->

Expected checkpoint

Someone else can reproduce and audit your work instead of trusting an unexplained final number.

Common errors + safe repair

- Starting with a chart/formula before understanding the data.
- Saving only screenshots and losing the actual workbook/formulas.
- Reporting "done" with no validation.

Recovery rule: stop at the earliest step where your result differs; repair that step, rerun the checkpoint, and only then continue.

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